



A touch of cloth

An Australian tailor has made it possible to make money transactions at a touch of your sleeve



Drones in North Dakota

Drones have made their way to farms in North Dakota. Check out the first of many to be approved by the FAA <http://dgit.in/faadrones>

Feature

go to print, this particular profile is following 46,684 members. Yes, it's probably a bot. But here's something strange – such a ridiculous profile has 2,077 people following it. These are the people you must target. Follow them and you're assured a follow-back, then simply unfollow! Mean, but effective.

You'll be sure to experience a sudden surge in your Quora followership overnight. This nifty trick will make your profile look impressive to everyone as you go about the business of answering questions on Quora. And if you're serious about participating on the forum, you can only expect the numbers to rise if your answers are intelligent or thought-provoking enough.

Also make it a habit to like, share, upvote, comment and retweet other people's interesting content. Do this mainly with content shared by a mainstream celebrity and you may just be able to weasel your way into their stream and improve your visibility without much effort. It's also recommended that you compliment, respond or positively comment on stuff shared by journalists and public relations people – they're more than happy to follow you and rarely have the time to unfollow you later.



Hashtag hopping

This is one of the easiest tricks in the game. Make hashtags a part of your online vocabulary and understand how to best discover and use them. The #discover option and the "Who To Follow" suggestions on Twitter are a great barometer of what people are interested in on any platform. Learn to embed trending hashtags nonchalantly into the flow of your content. Mention topics and hashtags in your status messages, tweets and even the questions you choose to answer on Quora. Of course,

you shouldn't add hashtags to your Quora until others are doing it first. You'd just look weird otherwise.

Freely use hashtags to chime in about ongoing events that are being discussed online. For example, if there's an IPL cricket match you'll find #IPL or some variation of it being floated around on the site. Join in the discussion and mention about such big events on your content feed. This will ensure that your name pops up on a highly viewed search list increasing your likelihood of being discovered. You're free to pick and choose your event. The closer it is to your tastes and profile, the more likely you are to gain new followers. The same trend applies to Quora votes, where your UpVotes across a number of questions highlight you to other viewers.

Catch a celeb

An easy way to boost your follower numbers is by engaging a bonafide celebrity in a public interaction. Whether they retweet your post or respond to your comment, any form of interaction gives you centre-stage exposure and instantly adds credibility to your brand. Start using the @message option to send compliments or support to celebrities and even risk asking them for a retweet of your messages. A little bit of gentle stalking doesn't hurt, so don't be afraid to send them a message up to twice a week. It's also highly advisable to find indie scale celebrities on Facebook and send them a friend request. You'll be surprised how often they say yes – just be sure to like their work beforehand.

Content and timing

Content is king, so start sharing links to blogs, lists, news, events and anything of relevance. It's important to avoid spammy content and focus on legitimate sources to retain your credibility and followers. When in doubt, just follow these two simple rules – don't share things that wastes people's time and share things that make your followers' lives better. Also, don't be afraid to express your opinions so your followers know there's human being behind that beautiful profile pic and not some bot.

Research has found that images and videos are more likely to attract attention and gain followers. Viral videos will also

do wonders for your likability online, so be on a lookout for those. Breaking news stories are another great way to make yourself relevant.

On more interactive platforms like Facebook or Quora, limit posts to twice or thrice a day so people don't think of you as a spammer. Occasionally, get in the habit of posting proactive messages such as



opinion seeking questions, go through the responses and like or reply to them to keep your engagement going with people who don't follow you.

And finally, don't mess up the timing! Knowing when to share is half the battle won. The best times to share updates, tweets or answers is when people are free to read them, so focus on the time just before work hours, during breaks and after work for maximum exposure. Maintaining this sort of schedule can be easier if you use a social media manager like Hootsuite, which can help you schedule your day's tweets in advance. Keep track of what your followers are finding interesting by observing the retweets, likes and upvotes. You can reshare the popular content again weeks or months later to impress your new followers.

Reign with honour

The long-term key to success in the social media sphere is the same as it is in real life – politeness and engagement. Best of luck on your conquests and be sure to follow Digit everywhere! 